32.1.3 Creating a Tag Helper to convert Markdown to HTML

The two Tag Helpers shown so far are agnostic to the content written inside the Tag Helper, but it can also be useful to create Tag Helpers that inspect, retrieve, and modify this content. In this section you'll see an example of one such Tag Helper that converts Markdown content written inside it to HTML.

DEFINITION Markdown is a commonly used text-based markup language that is easy to read but can also be converted to HTML. It is the common format used by README files on GitHub, and I use it to write blog posts, for example. For an introduction to Markdown, see the GitHub guide at http://mng.bz/o1rp.

We'll use the popular Markdig library (https://github.com/xoofx/markdig) to create the Markdown Tag Helper. This library converts a `string` containing Markdown to an HTML `string`. You can install Markdig using Visual Studio by running `dotnet add package Markdig` or by adding a `<PackageReference>` to your .csproj file:

```
<PackageReference Include="Markdig" Version="0.30.4" />
```

The Markdown Tag Helper that we'll create shortly can be used by adding `<markdown>` elements to your Razor Page, as shown in the following listing.

Listing 32.3 Using a Markdown Tag Helper in a Razor Page

```
@page
@model IndexModel
@{
```